ELVIS ZAK MASEMBE

UX/UI Designer

elvizyzak8@gmail.com | Portfolio | LinkedIn | GitHub | Ottawa, ON

PROFILE

UX/UI designer with a front-end development background and an Interactive Media Design diploma from Algonquin College (Dean's Honours List). Takes products from user research and personas through information architecture, wireframes, and design systems to tested, high-fidelity prototypes, and can code them in HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and React. Brings 3+ years of freelance design for startups and local businesses, 15+ multimedia projects delivered, and client work with Nova Studio that won a Participants' Choice Award.

SKILLS

UX/UI design: Wireframing (lo-fi to hi-fi) · Interactive prototyping · Design systems & component libraries · Information architecture & sitemaps · User flows & journey maps · Responsive, mobile-first & accessible design · Visual design & branding

Research: User interviews · Usability testing · Personas · Competitive analysis · Research synthesis · Design Thinking

Design tools: Figma, Figma Make · Adobe XD · Sketch · Adobe Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign · Adobe Premiere Pro, After Effects, Audition · Miro · Canva

Front-end & CMS: HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, TypeScript · React, Tailwind CSS, Bootstrap · WordPress, Shopify, Drupal, PHP · Git, GitHub

SELECTED PROJECTS

RentEasy Uganda – Rental Marketplace *2026*

Solo Product Designer | elviszak-porfolio.site/projects/renteasy-uganda

- Designed a broker-free, three-sided mobile marketplace connecting renters, property owners and housekeepers in Uganda, after weighing 3 product concepts against the problem of broker markups and untrusted home services
- Ran usability tests with real renters and property owners; synthesized findings into 3 personas (renter, owner, housekeeper) and end-to-end user journeys
- Iterated through 3 prototype versions: added guest browsing when testers wanted to explore before signing up, then a full housekeeper role with its own sign-up, dashboard and accept/decline flow
- Built a coded, interactive prototype in React and TypeScript (via Figma Make) with 40+ screens across 3 role-based flows, carrying state such as selected listings and live basket pricing between screens
- Created a design system (5-colour palette, shared header, navigation, cards and buttons) and designed for local constraints: Android-first, usable on 3G, and clear for low-to-mid tech literacy
- Embedded the live, fully interactive prototype in the portfolio case study inside a custom iPhone-style frame, so reviewers can tap through the real app as if on a phone

Tallya – Public Safety Mobile App (Team Project) *Spring 2026*

UX/UI Designer & Documentation Lead, 5-person team | Client: Nova Studio | elviszak-porfolio.site/projects/tallya

- Co-designed Tallya, a discreet safety app connecting Ottawa nightlife patrons (ByWard Market, Elgin Street) with venue staff, for client Nova Studio over a 15-week engagement with weekly client meetings
- Owned the tablet version of the staff app: designed its screens and components (dashboard, requests, patron details, messaging and incident logging) and built its interactive Figma prototype
- Contributed to competitive analysis (bSafe, Noonlight), 3 personas, patron and staff journey maps, and tablet-based prototype testing that shaped key design decisions
- Helped design 2 rounds of information architecture, the brand identity and component library, and the patron app's hi-fi prototype
- Led team documentation (design rationale, research records, meeting notes) through 5 client sign-off milestones, and co-built the 24-slide findings presentation and final handoff package
- Won the Participants' Choice Award at Algonquin College's Spring 2026 Technology Project Showcase

Active Life Center – Community Fitness Website *July 2025*

UX/UI Designer & Web Developer | elviszak-porfolio.site/projects/active-life-center

- Followed a Design Thinking process: user interviews and personas surfaced distinct needs for students (fast mobile scheduling), families (clear kids' programs, multi-child registration) and seniors (readable text, visible help)
- Designed solutions for each: age and skill filters with "recommended for" labels, one-checkout multi-child registration, a mobile-first layout with sticky navigation, and larger, higher-contrast type
- Moved from low-fidelity wireframes to hi-fi Figma mock-ups and a clickable prototype, refining it from test feedback against a target of a parent finding a suitable program in under a minute
- Coded the final responsive site in HTML, CSS, JavaScript and Bootstrap, tested it on real devices and deployed it with GitHub Pages

Anime Sticker & Figure Store – Shopify E-commerce Site *2025*

Web Designer | elviszak-porfolio.site/projects/anime-sticker-miniature-figure-store

- Designed and launched a live Shopify storefront with a featured product grid, collection pages filtered by price and availability, a blog and a contact page
- Added conversion features: a free-shipping threshold bar, a single promo countdown timer, sale badges and email signup

EXPERIENCE

Freelance Graphic & Digital Designer *Jan 2023 – Present*

Ottawa, ON

- Designed brand identities, logos and marketing assets for schools, startups and local businesses
- Advised clients on UI layout and visual hierarchy to improve website navigation and engagement
- Produced social media graphics and ads in Adobe Photoshop, Illustrator and Canva
- Managed clients remotely from brief to final files, gathering feedback and iterating to meet tight deadlines

Freelance Photographer & Videographer *Jan 2024 – Present*

Ottawa, ON

- Shoot portrait, event and product photography with professional DSLR equipment; edit in Lightroom, Premiere Pro, After Effects and Audition
- Create short-form video for clients' social media campaigns
- Work with clients to understand their vision, delivering multimedia packages on tight deadlines and earning repeat business

Hotel Housekeeping (Part-Time) *2023 – 2025*

Fairfield by Marriott | Ottawa, ON

EDUCATION

Interactive Media Design Diploma *Jan 2025 – Aug 2026*

Algonquin College | Ottawa, ON

- Cumulative GPA 3.8/4.0 | Dean’s Honours List

LEADERSHIP & VOLUNTEER

Class Representative – Interactive Media Design Program *May 2025 – Aug 2026*

Algonquin College | Ottawa, ON

- Represented 60 students in program meetings, bringing student concerns and ideas to coordinators
- Acted as liaison between students and coordinators to resolve academic and scheduling issues
- Organized group study sessions and feedback forums, and promoted student engagement in college events

Student Orientation Volunteer *May 2025 (Orientation Week)*

Algonquin College | Ottawa, ON

- Guided incoming students around campus and answered questions about schedules, resources and procedures, easing their move into college life
- Helped create a positive first impression of Algonquin College through professional and helpful interactions